



Leonardo spent much of his time in Rome carrying out scientific investigations. One important source of the Medici family's wealth at the time was making dyes to color clothing. Leonardo experimented with mirrors, trying to build a solar reflector that would focus sunlight to boil the ingredients of the dyes in less than the usual time.

Leonardo, at 61 years of age, was no longer a young man, but he could be distracted just as easily as ever. Vasari wrote that Leonardo amused himself making "little animals of a wax paste, which as he walked along he

